

ACT I / Discovery 01

Board Draft: The Naming Gift

A draft agreement proposes renaming the institution 'The Grant Larceny Meridian Museum' and gives the donor extraordinary influence over future acquisitions.

ACT I / Discovery 02

Geneva Shipping Manifest

A 1988 shipping record routes the Isfahan Star Bowl through a Geneva freeport under a shell company called Northstar Holdings. The owner line is blacked out.

ACT I / Discovery 03

Unsigned Warning

*RETURN WHAT WAS TAKEN BEFORE THE STAR GOES DARK.
No signature. The paper is ordinary museum stationery.*

ACT I / Discovery 04

Embargoed Headline

A printout from Paige Turner's notebook reads: 'THE MISSING
DECADE IN THE LARCENY COLLECTION - HOLD FOR 9:00
PM.'

ACT I / Discovery 05

Conservation Note

Chip Patina flagged modern adhesive beneath the Star Bowl's base, suggesting the object was remounted later than the public catalogue claims.

ACT I / Discovery 06

Legal Margin Note

On a draft donor agreement, someone has written: 'Permanent title does not cure disputed title.' The initials are S.V.

ACT I / Discovery 07

Auction Catalogue

A lot in an old auction catalogue is circled twice. In the margin:
'E.M. beat G.L. through proxy buyer. He will never forgive this.'

ACT I / Discovery 08

Student Painting Card

A label mock-up describes an 'early student work by Vincent Van Faux, loaned by Grant Larceny.' Someone has written NO in thick pencil across the proof.

ACT I / Discovery 09

Education Budget

A draft budget moves money away from school tours and community programs toward a private donor lounge and new VIP entrance.

ACT I / Discovery 10

Camera Work Order

The Donor Salon security camera was intentionally taken offline for 'private donor meetings' during the gala.

ACT I / Discovery 11

1989 Accession Page

An old accession notebook records one of Grant Larceny's earliest gifts with the note: 'Export papers promised - not yet received.'

ACT I / Discovery 12

Performance Sketch

A concept drawing by Dada DiCapo resembles the gala's final reveal almost exactly, but the printed program credits the spectacle only to 'The Larceny Foundation.'

ACT I / Discovery 13

Condition Photo

A setup photograph shows a faint crescent scratch already present on the cap of a replica service decanter used in the gallery display.

ACT I / Discovery 14

Crate Seal

A broken shipping seal from a recent crate is stamped NORTHSTAR LOGISTICS. Cary Crates has written: 'Why is this name back?'

ACT I / Discovery 15

Lighting Cue Sheet

The centerpiece lights flickered during rehearsal because someone changed the programmed cue after approval. The revised sequence is initialed M.M.

ACT I / Discovery 16

Private Menu Card

Grant's service note says: 'Private cordial in silver coupe. No garnish. Deliver to Donor Salon before remarks.'

ACT II / F1 / Staged release

The private toast

Grant Larceny has died from a botanical cardiac toxin applied inside his private silver coupe and along its rim. The cordial decanter and buffet food are clean. Service staff have been cleared. One guest acted alone.

ACT II / F2 / Staged release

Grant's unfinished business

Grant's papers concern the naming agreement, disputed objects, unpaid invoices, a rewritten family trust and threats to careers. His handwriting appears beside several guests' names. Before considering access to the drink, ask what each guest stood to lose.

ACT II / F3 / Staged release

The salon door register

The coupe and its rim were checked clean when the cordial was poured at 6:40; Grant drank at 6:49. The glass remained inside the Donor Salon. A door steward logged every guest entry and checked faces against badge photographs. No other entrance was open. The steward could see the door, not the service table. A visit before 6:40 is outside the poisoning window. The cabinet key book is also being checked.

ACT III / F4 / Staged release

The missing conservation sample

The toxin sample was in a locked cabinet at 6:00 and missing at 6:35. There was one key, loaned to guests during setup and logged by the materials desk. The cabinet was relocked after each loan; there were no unlogged openings or duplicate keys. No key or sample was passed between guests. Several perfectly ordinary errands involved borrowing that key.

ACT III / F5 / Staged release

A thread in the poison

Concentrated toxin inside the coupe and on its rim follows linen wipe tracks. A gold thread is trapped in that poisoned smear: a toxin-dampened cloth applied the poison, rather than merely cleaning up afterward. The thread matches the museum's white linen with gold seams. Guests received that linen or blue paper wipes; blue paper cannot leave this thread. The 6:39 inventory records what each guest carried. Spare linen stayed sealed; no cloth was exchanged. Linen possession alone does not identify the poisoner.

EVIDENCE TABLE / Release order

Three releases, three rounds

Read F1–F2 before Motive. Read F3 before Opportunity. Read F4–F5 before Method. Guests select their assigned A/B preparation receipt only when Method begins. Ask their named question, hear their answer, then read their receipt. Compare all the records before voting.